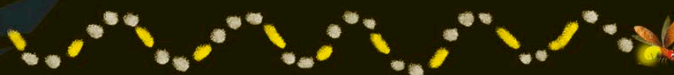




Photinus pyralis
("Big dipper")



Photinus ignitus



Photinus consanguineus



Photinus carolinus
(synchronous firefly)

Unique signals

Each species of firefly has its own pattern of lights. Some glow continuously, while others flicker and flash at regular intervals.

Dancing together



Synchronous fireflies can flash the same pattern at the same time. Millions of them come together in summer to put on a display.



A firefly's glow is the world's most efficient light. It loses almost zero energy as heat.

Finding a mate



Males and females use their lights to talk to each other and find mates.